

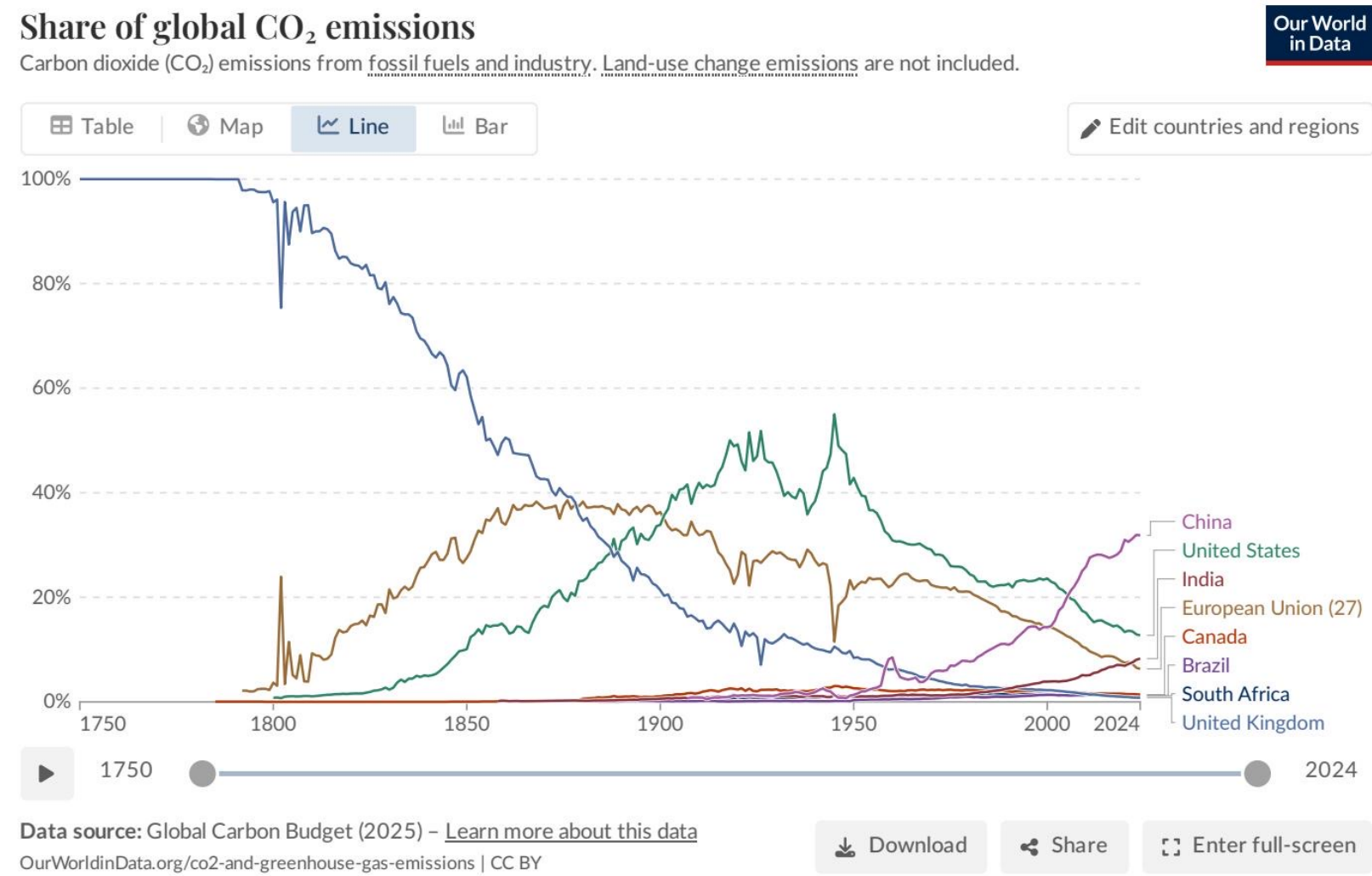
Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Scope: fossil fuels & industry, 1750–2024

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 (via Our World in Data)

Audience: policy analysts, climate negotiators, sustainability researchers

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Inflection points

- Pre-industrial: near-zero
- Post-1950: rapid acceleration
- Recent years: slower growth, but no peak

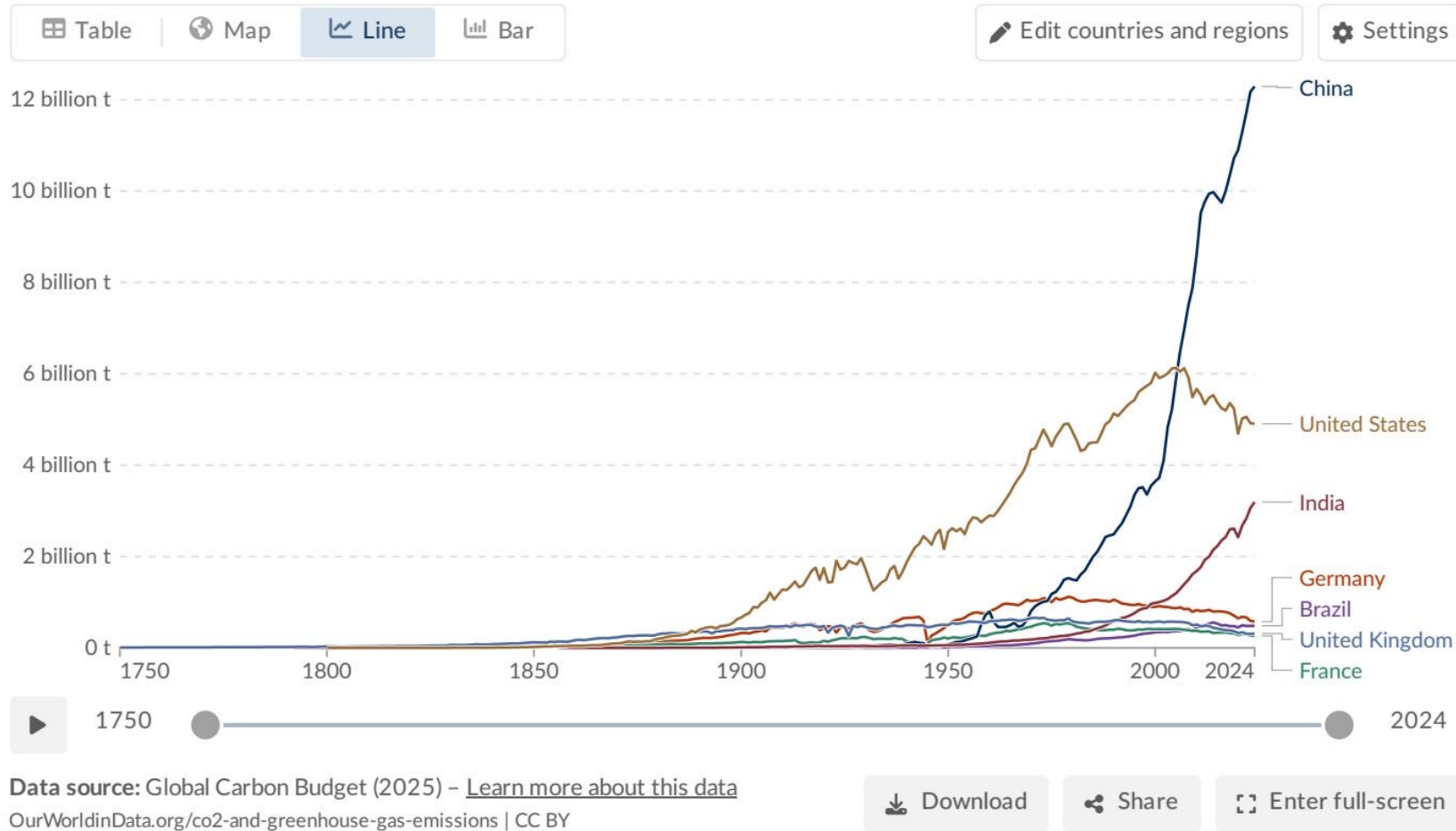
Scale (fossil + industry)

1950: ~6 Bt CO₂/yr
1990: >20 Bt CO₂/yr
Today: >35 Bt CO₂/yr

Reading the chart

Land-use change has declined slightly, but fossil-fuel emissions dominate the total.

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



Share shift

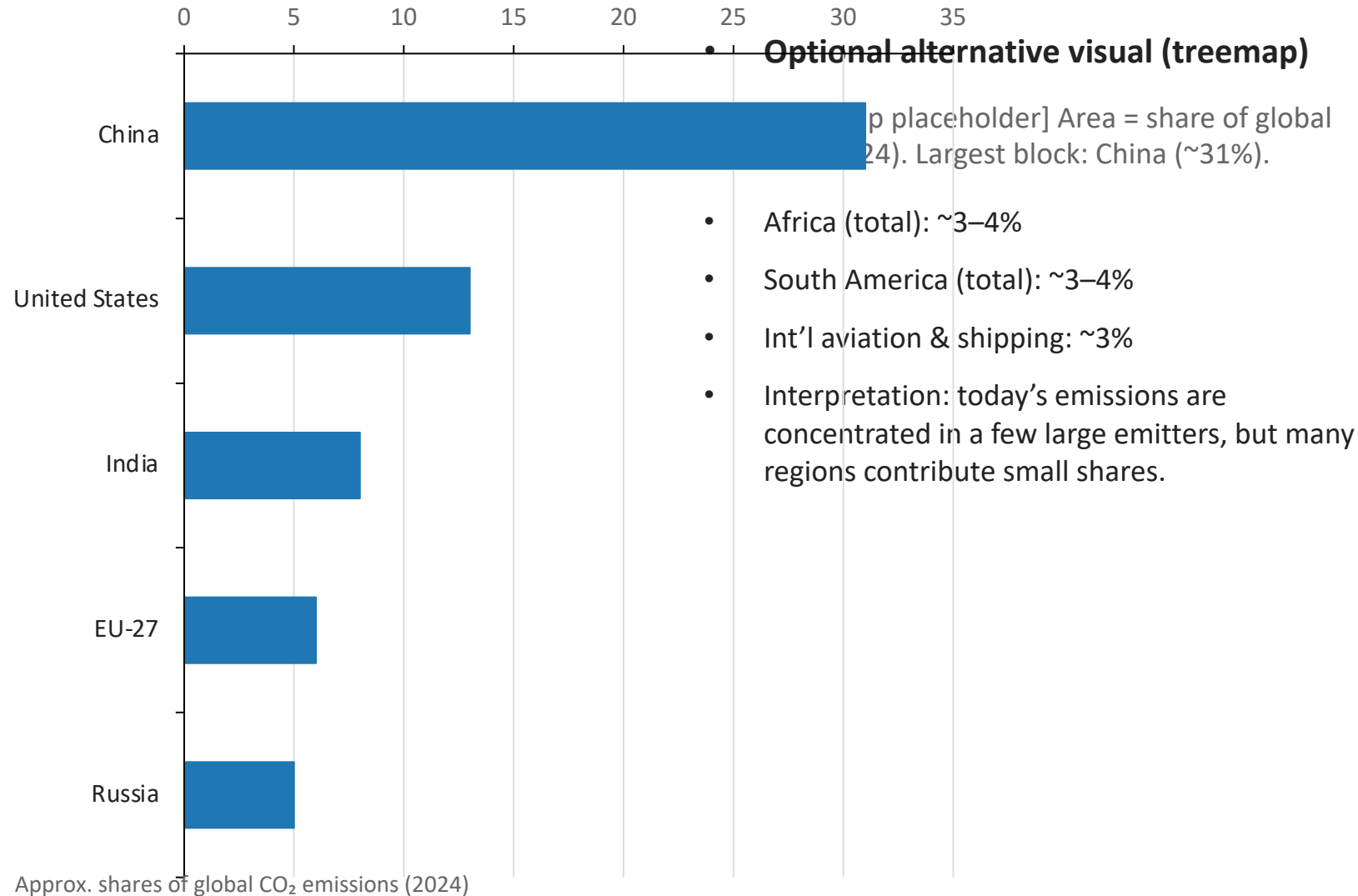
1900: Europe + US >90%
1950: still >85%
Today: <1/3 (declining)

Asia rises

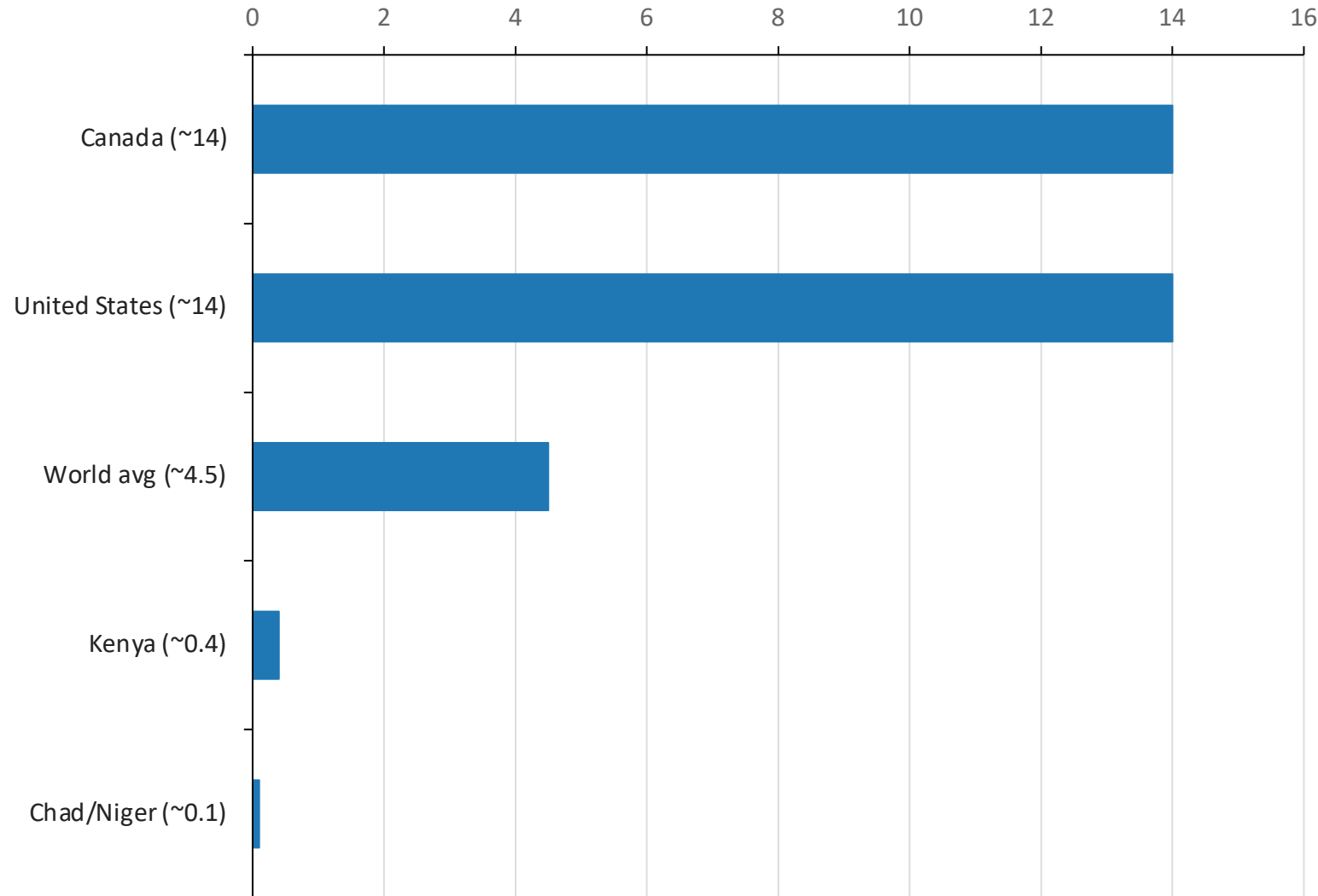
Asia now produces roughly half of global emissions — led by China.

Africa and South America each: ~3–4% (similar to int'l aviation & shipping: ~3%).

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



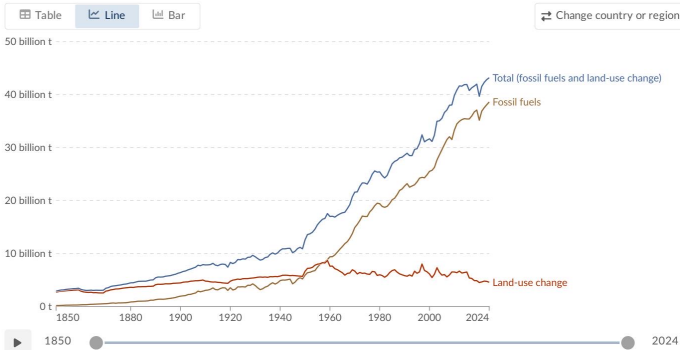
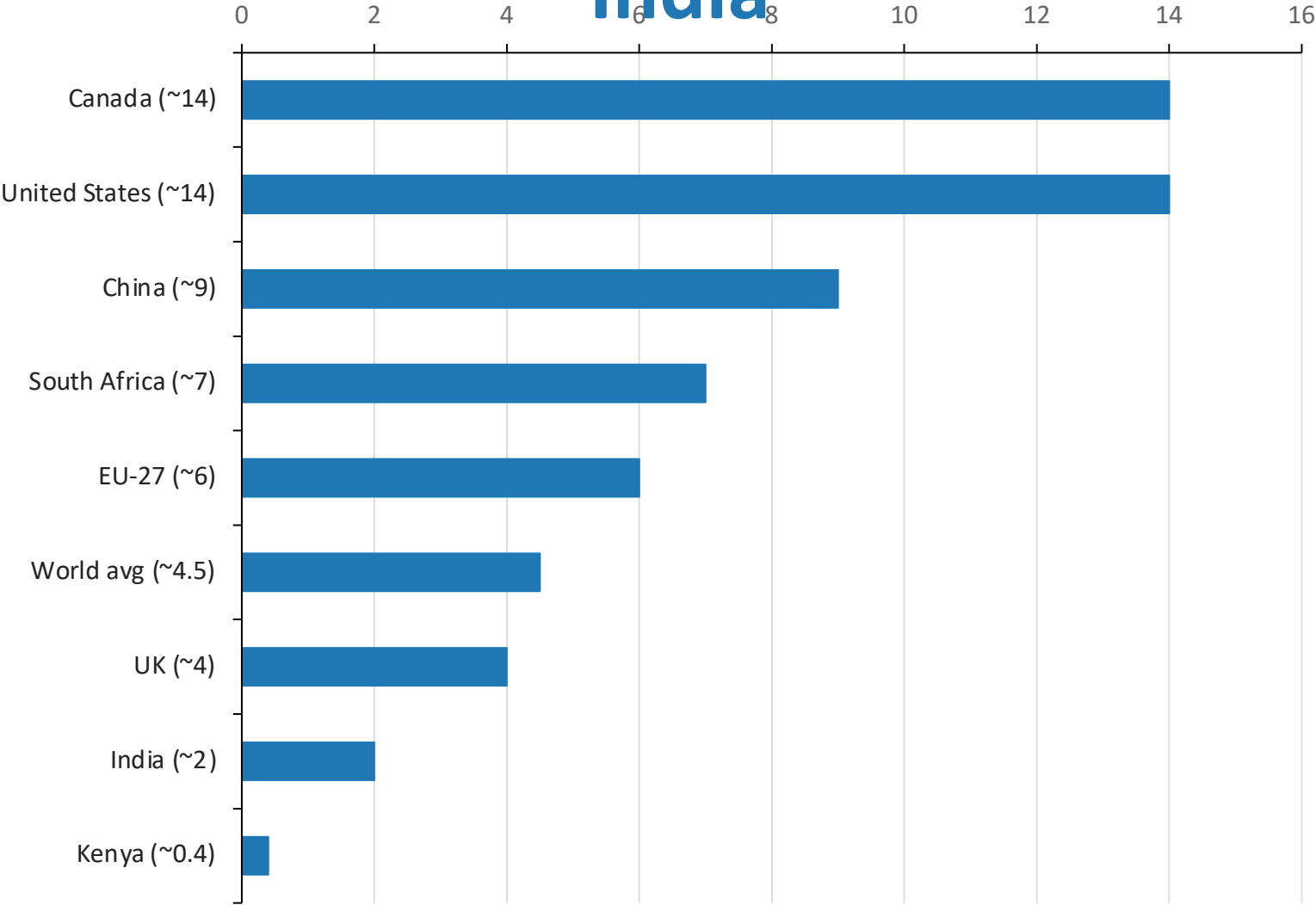
150× gap

~14 t/person vs ~0.1 t/person
= roughly 150× difference between
high and very low emitters.

Reframing responsibility

High totals do not map 1:1 to high
per-capita emissions. Even among
wealthy nations, per-capita varies
widely (e.g., US vs UK/France).

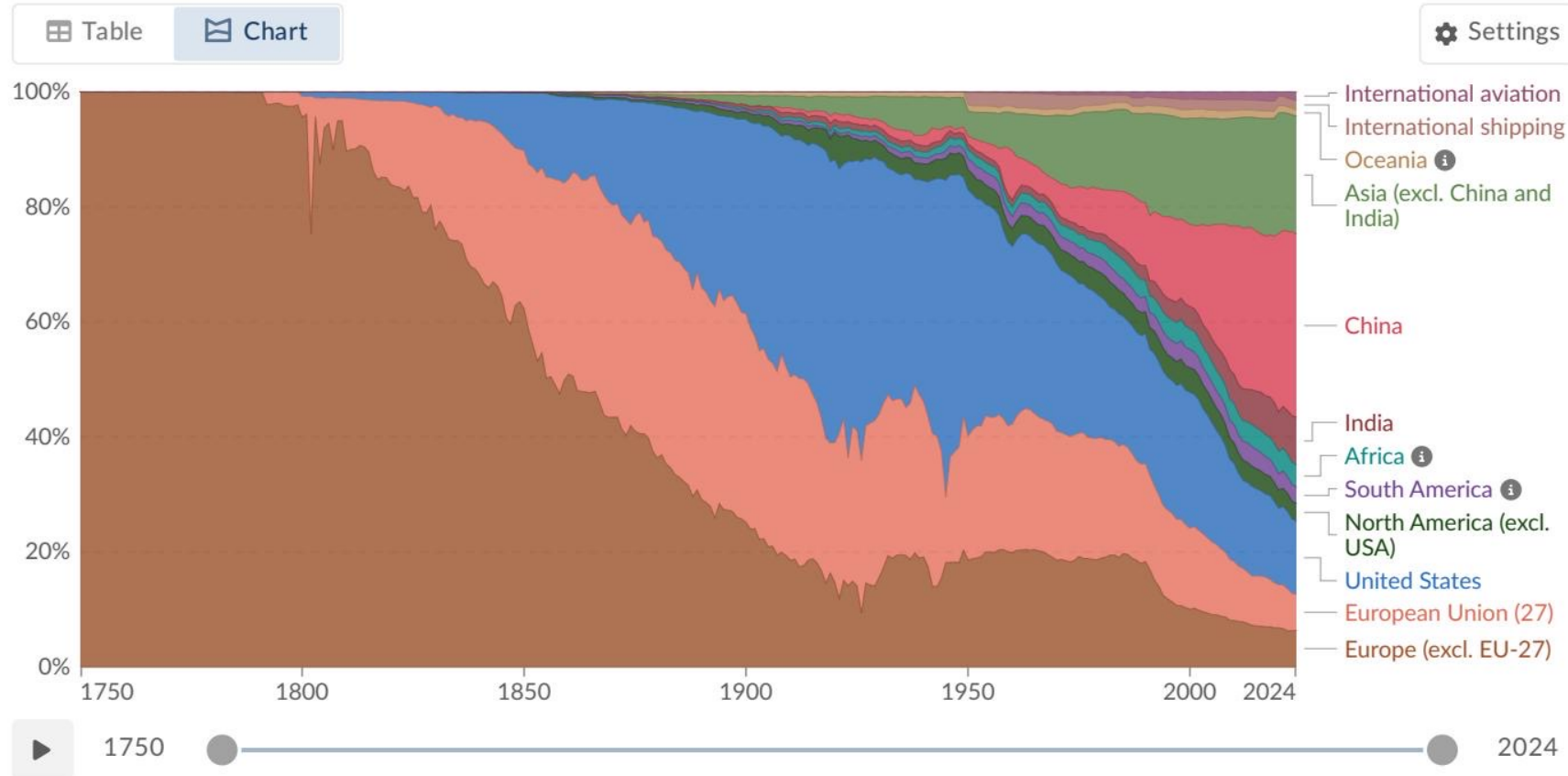
Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



Key comparison

China is the largest total emitter, but per-capita (~9 t) remains below the US/Canada (~14 t). India remains low (~2 t).

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Data source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)
OurWorldinData.org/co2-and-greenhouse-gas-emissions | CC BY

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Declines

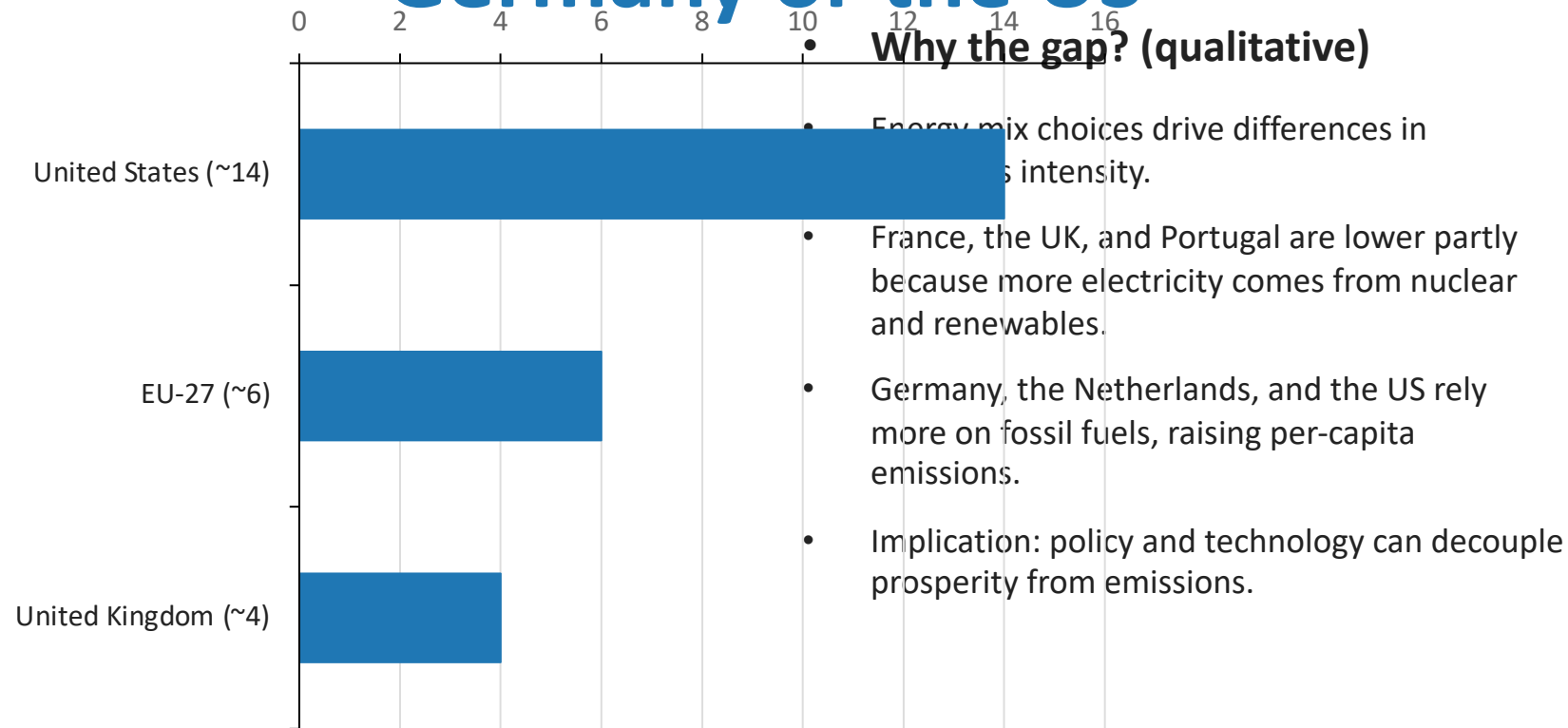
US, much of the EU, and the UK show declines (blue shading).

Increases

Russia, parts of Southeast Asia, and several African nations increased (orange/red).

Central Asia: some countries >10% increase.

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Wealthy countries can have very different per-capita emissions.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- Global CO₂ emissions from fossil fuels & industry exceed 35 Bt/yr — and have not yet peaked (growth has slowed).
- China is the largest annual emitter (~31% of global CO₂), but per-capita (~9 t) remains below the US/Canada (~14 t).
- Historical responsibility shifted: Europe + US were >90% of emissions in 1900, but are now less than one-third.
- Per-capita gaps of roughly 150× persist between very low emitters (~0.1 t/person) and high-emitting wealthy nations (~14–15 t/person).
- Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions (e.g., lower per-capita in the UK/France).